

Let It Bleed

or

You Can't Always Get What You Want
*(But if you try sometimes, well, you might find
You get what you need)*
(7 October 2026)

An open letter to my son Arthur ¹

On September 28, 2026, a dear friend of fifty years, who lives more than one thousand kilometers away and whom I haven't seen in nearly a decade, acted graciously as a remote messenger and sent you and Jacqueline, your mother, a link to my main [GitHub file repository](#).

Five days later, after nearly seven years of unbroken silence, you apparently deleted all our past WhatsApp correspondence and replaced it with one single link:



¹ Born 1986.

In attempting to find a logical equivalent to the song verses, I propose:

Some of what you want you can never get, while
Trying is not enough to get even what is just needed,
With the consequence that
How do you get what you need just to survive?

The messenger has observed to me, however, that it is the fate of most, if not of all, to never obtain anything of what one wants, a position which plain experience seems to contradict.

To test the logic of this view against the physical reality of life, please find hereafter a limited list of things I would want, let alone would need, accompanied by some remarks.

As a preamble, please recall that I live in total seclusion and isolation since you quit visiting and calling, a long ways from the closest neighbor, my only company being animal life, in particular seven (or eight, depending on the day) half-feral dogs, who do provide not only good and faithful company, but also the only security there is in these remote parts.

Because a common psychological defense against the deeply unpleasant is plain denial, sometimes to the point of absurdity, I ask anyone reading this paper to indicate in the two columns to the right of the table below whether my circumstances are, in fact, absolutely common (Column C) or, on the contrary, quite uncommon (Column U)

I am unsure that nobody would ever get satisfaction for any of the suggestions:

1. A series of visits to the dentist to repair six painful broken molars, the last visit dating back 26 years ago;
2. A series of visits to the clinic necessary to operate the two massive painful inguinal hernias that occurred 9 years ago as a consequence of hard work done without any help;
3. Assisted weeks-long convalescence at home after each operation;
4. Some medical attention at the age of 72, noting that my last visit to a physician dates back nearly 16 years ago;
5. Some treatment for the four syncope with short cardiac arrests I experienced in total solitude on September 6, 2026, between the hours of 11 AM and 2 PM,;
6. Some consideration for three shorter losses of consciousness I experienced on the afternoon of September 28, upon learning the messenger's refusal to communicate the link above to a larger random audience;
7. The reestablishment of mail delivery to my isolated location, which was interrupted four months ago and precludes timely package delivery (on the bright side, the grocery store located 32 kilometers away continues its monthly deliveries);
8. The ability to obtain basic prescription glasses;
9. The ability to obtain an operation on my left eye for what seems to be cataract;
10. Access to transportation, the lack of which has barred me from ever leaving my property in the past seven years, even for a minute;

- 11.** An end to the complete seizure of my bank accounts, including of the legally unseizable minimum bank balance of 650 euros;
- 12.** The return of nearly two million dollars owed to me, which has been denied through a decade of fraudulent legal actions across two countries and ten separate courts of law;
- 13.** An end to the complete seizure my house and property;
- 14.** Reparation and compensation for the nearly consummated desecration and spoliation of our cemetery family vault at the hands of the local government;
- 15.** Reparation and compensation for the environmental destruction of large tracts of my property by governmental action;
- 16.** Reparation and compensation for the illegal diversion of my water table, rivers, and springs at the hands of the local government, with the resulting total dry-up of water resources eight months out of the year and the corresponding steep loss of property value;
- 17.** Correction of the fraudulent assessment of my property for tax purposes;
- 18.** Consideration of my very limited income of 800 euros per month;
- 19.** Consideration of the fact that I never had beefsteak, or a dish of fish, in more than seven years;
- 20.** Explanation of the refusal by my only son to tell the world why he has refused to communicate with me in the past seven years;

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">21. Explanation of the refusal by my only son to tell the world what it is that is so unpleasant that he won't tell?22. Explanation as to why I consistently ask our common friends to beg my son to tell the world the reason for his refusal, if it is so unpleasant?23. The reestablishment of access to basic indoor sanitation;24. Access to garbage disposal, which I haven't had for 9 years, despite being charged 7,700 euros for it. | | |
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among numerous other things I indeed would want, let alone would need.

If it is truly the basic fate of **nobody** on Earth to ever get what is wanted or just needed for survival, then these checked lines above should reveal that my daily existence is completely ordinary.

However, if the lines reveal some departure from the ordinary, then the narrative that **nobody** ever gets what is wanted is exposed as an empty shield used to avoid a very specific truth.

I have consistently pleaded with all our common friends to ask you for an explanation of your choices, of course not to assign blame to my only son, who is to me irreplaceable, as are my oldest friends, but to reestablish unvarnished or unadulterated communication.

If you think there is something so unpleasant that it has caused seven years of total silence and abandonment, I am prepared to debate it with facts and logic.